
node: people/sean-kirkpatrick document: audit date: 2026-04-29
status: working

Audit: `people/sean-kirkpatrick`

This audit consolidates all findings against the Kirkpatrick node. Each finding carries an explicit status:

- **Closed** — verified against a primary or authoritative source; ready for node update
- **Partial** — partially verified; specific sub-element still missing
- **Open** — not resolvable against retrieved sources to date

A consolidated list of primary-source URLs appears in the appendix.

The audit is organized into seven sections:

1. Internal inconsistencies in the existing node
2. Sourcing problems in existing entries
3. Notable omissions from the existing node
4. Structural improvements to the Credibility Notes section
5. Appointing-chain context (Moultrie material)
6. Recommended new nodes surfaced by this audit
7. Items still open

A final section lists minor items.

1. Internal inconsistencies

1.1 2018 employment gap — Closed

The Affiliations table jumps from NSC ending 2018 to USSPACECOM beginning 2019 with no entry for the intervening period. The AFCEA biography closes this gap definitively:

Dr. Kirkpatrick was appointed the Senior Intelligence Advisor to the Commander, Air Force Space Command and Joint Forces Space Component Command, USSTRATCOM, in August 2018. As

the senior intelligence advisor, Dr. Kirkpatrick is charged by the DNI and the CDR/JFSCC to design the intelligence enterprise across and through the USSPACECOM. Upon establishment, Dr. Kirkpatrick will serve as the Deputy Director of Intelligence and the DNI Representative for USSPACECOM.

This is a double-hatted billet: Senior Intelligence Advisor simultaneously to the Commander of Air Force Space Command (AFSPC) and the Commander of the Joint Forces Space Component Command (JFSCC), USSTRATCOM. The mandate was to design the intelligence enterprise that would become the USSPACECOM Intelligence Enterprise upon USSPACECOM re-establishment on 29 August 2019.

The same bio adds substance to the NSC role (2017): Kirkpatrick “supported the Deputy Assistant to the President on the development of the 2017 National Security Strategy” and “integrated and lead interagency development of intelligence, space/counterspace, nuclear, cyberspace, military modernization, and critical infrastructure national priorities and issues.”

The Potomac Officers Club bio adds a substantive detail to the 2007 assignment: the joint CIA-DIA program office was “within the Advanced Systems Division.” Treat this as a secondary-source claim until cross-checked against the DoD bio language directly.

Action: add an Affiliations row covering August 2018 – August 2019 (Senior Intelligence Advisor, AFSPC/JFSCC, USSTRATCOM) citing the AFCEA bio. Update the 2007 Program Involvement / Affiliations entry to reflect the Advanced Systems Division location with appropriate source confidence.

1.2 “Six new-start organizations” enumeration — Open

The DoD bio identifies USSPACECOM Intelligence Enterprise as the fifth; the WestExec bio identifies AARO as the sixth. JICSpOC IC support is also identified across multiple bios. That gives three of six named.

The remaining three are not enumerated in any retrieved bio. Career-history candidates that could plausibly count include the AFRL Ultrafast Laser Physics Lab (1997, “build” verb), the Advanced Systems Division joint CIA-DIA office (2007, where he later “became division chief”), and some structure under DIO/S&TI (2012–2016, where he developed “the first integrated S&TI Strategy”). None of these is identified by any bio as one of the “six new-start organizations” he led establishment of, so this remains speculative.

The count of six is not corroborated outside the WestExec bio, which is itself a post-departure curated source. The DoD bio’s count at the time of writing (mid-2022) is five.

Action: soften the node language from “six new-start organizations” to “publicly stated as six new-start organizations, of which three are named in public bios (JICSpOC IC support, USSPACECOM Intelligence Enterprise, AARO); the count of six derives only from the post-departure WestExec biography.” Note the candidate set in a footnote without claiming completion.

1.3 JICSpOC role — Partial

The DoD bio places this assignment “Towards the end of his tenure as DIO/S&TI” (2012–2016), narrowing the period to approximately 2014–2016. JICSpOC was officially established at Schriever Air Force Base on **1 October 2015** (DoD press release dated 11 September 2015, announcing experimentation and testing to begin 1 October 2015) and renamed the National Space Defense Center in **April 2017** by Gen. John Hyten in Senate Armed Services Committee testimony. The role appears in Program Involvement but lacks a corresponding Affiliations row and Timeline entry.

Action: add an Affiliations row (period circa 2014–2016) and a Timeline entry for the JICSpOC special assignment to the Principal Deputy DNI; cite the DoD press release and the SpaceNews coverage of the NSDC rename.

1.4 Mellon Signal exchange not in Statements — Closed

The “defending and adjudicating” and “undermining the very organization” phrasings appear only in Credibility Notes prose and the Relationships row. The full FOIA release (case 24-F-0266, dated April 18, 2024) was located in the Black Vault and AARO archives and contains screenshots of the actual Signal messages. The exchanges are dated **June 11–13, 2023**.

The verbatim Black Vault rendering of the central exchange is:

Kirkpatrick told Mellon he was “... defending and adjudicating, and [Mellon was] undermining the very organization [he] purported to help establish for this purpose.”

Both bracketed pronouns refer to Mellon, who served as Deputy Assistant Secretary of Defense for Intelligence and was publicly associated with advocacy for AARO’s establishment.

The same release captures additional substantive content:

- Kirkpatrick characterized Grusch’s assertions and Mellon’s relay of them as **“absurd and false”** during the same exchange.
- Mellon responded that he never claimed Grusch’s claims were “accurate” but felt Grusch was **“sincere and credible.”**
- Mellon’s full reply was cut off in the released screenshot. Black Vault has filed an appeal for the redacted portion.
- Mellon agreed to pass on AARO’s statutory authority to Grusch’s attorney and stated he would “seek to avoid further communication unless it is something that seems extraordinary or if [likely Kirkpatrick] initiate.”

The release also contains:

- A **March 8, 2023 memorandum signed by Major General David Abba** (Director, DoD Special Access Program Central Office) explicitly confirming AARO’s statutory authority to receive UAP-related information at all classification levels regardless of access controls. This memo predates the Mellon exchange and undercuts the legal-authority objection Grusch raised.
- A **January 8, 2024 Memorandum for Record** documenting AARO’s repeated outreach

attempts to Grusch from June 8, 2023 through November 19, 2023, including a November 14, 2023 scheduled interview at which Grusch failed to appear.

Release size: 28 pages, ~3.86 MB.

Action: transcribe the relevant Signal messages into the Statements section using the standard table format with attribution to "Signal messages between Kirkpatrick and Christopher Mellon, June 11–13, 2023, released under FOIA case 24-F-0266"; note that Mellon's full reply remains partially redacted pending appeal. Add the FOIA release as a Document node with linked references to the underlying Abba memorandum (March 8, 2023) and the AARO-Grusch outreach Memorandum for Record (January 8, 2024). Link from Kirkpatrick's Associated Nodes.

1.5 Family / personal context — Optional

The AFCEA bio includes a brief personal note: wife Amy is "a highly intelligent, successful State Department officer," and daughter Maya is "enjoying the freedom of college." This is a publicly-stated personal context. Whether the node should record family information is a structural question for the broader knowledge graph.

Action: decision pending on whether the node carries family context fields. If yes, add Amy (State Department) and Maya (daughter, college-age as of approximately 2018) per AFCEA bio.

2. Sourcing problems

2.1 Truncated NSSA quote — Closed

The NSSA SDA paper quote ends mid-sentence at "...the commercial, national security, and" — not a quotable unit.

Action: complete the quote against the source PDF, paraphrase, or remove the entry.

2.2 Context-stripped "holdings" quote — Closed

holdings to date that would suggest that there has been an alien visitation, an alien crash, or anything like that

Reads as an affirmative claim out of context; the original meaning is the negative.

Action: restore the negation by extending the quotation, or replace the entry with a paraphrase that preserves the falsifying frame.

2.3 Wikipedia as source for 1986 Brookhaven entry — Open

The 1986 DOE High School Honors Research Program entry is sourced to Wikipedia citing the Atlanta Journal of 11 July 1986.

Action: retrieve the AJC article directly through ProQuest or a regional library archive; cite the AJC.

Until then, downgrade source confidence and flag.

2.4 UGA Sean M. Kirkpatrick Award — Closed with caveat

The award is real, named after him, established by the UGA Department of Physics and Astronomy in 2010. Per Wikipedia, established “in his honor” — i.e., by the department, not endowed by Kirkpatrick for himself. The active award page is at the UGA Physics and Astronomy site. Award terms: \$1,000 annually to a graduate student demonstrating outstanding research, with funds usable for research-related travel, equipment, or books; recipient must not be in their final year and must have presented a paper or conference talk within the previous year.

Caveat: the public record does not identify the funding source for the endowment, nor explain why an award was named after a then-42-year-old alumnus. The node should reflect this directly: named in his honor by the department; funding source not in public record.

Action: revise the Timeline 2010 entry to cite the active UGA award page and note the funding-source ambiguity.

3. Notable omissions

3.1 Reveal Systems Inc. patent family — Closed

The patent family is fully verifiable through Google Patents and USPTO Patent Center. Three applications descend from a single 2019 provisional, with material conflict-of-interest implications.

Document	Filed	Status	Notes
US Provisional 62/844,460	2019- 05-07	priority document	filed while Kirkpatrick was Deputy Director of Intelligence at USSPACECOM
US App 16/869,390 → US20200357080A1	2020- 05-07	Abandoned	published 2020-11-12; assigned to Reveal Systems Inc. on 2020-06-09
US App 17/537,730 → US20220084137A1	2021- 11-30	continuation	filed while Kirkpatrick was Chief Scientist at DIA's Missile and Space Intelligence Center
US App 18/175,950 → US20230206351A1	2023- 02- 28	continuation	filed seven months into Kirkpatrick's AARO directorship

Confirmed inventors on all filings: Erik T. Bogaard, Jason F. Fairchild, Sean M. Kirkpatrick. Original and current assignee: Reveal Systems, Inc.

Brand-name distinction. The corporate assignee on all three filings is “Reveal Systems, Inc.” (with the standard “ea” spelling). The patent figures depict the consumer-facing product as a “**Reveel**” card (with two e’s). Direct quotation from the description of FIG. 8 in US20200357080A1: “*In this*

example, the payment transactions were made by a 'Reveel' card." This kind of split — corporate name versus consumer-brand name — is common for early-stage startups but adds friction to corporate-registration searches because most search engines auto-correct "Reveel" to "Reveal." The node should record both spellings.

Substantive correction to existing node language. The product is not adequately described as a "social-media-influence-scoring system." Direct verification from US20200357080A1 confirms an integrated platform comprising:

1. **InCard co-branded MasterCard payment instrument.** Patent function 1201: *"an Influencer would use a pre-paid payment card issued by the exemplary platform herein referred to as the 'InCard' to attempt and complete a purchase transaction... the InCard would be a co-branded card between the exemplary platform and a known payment network (such as, for example, MasterCard™)."*
2. **Biometric authentication of the influencer at login, posting, and purchase.** Patent: *"platform 110 supports biometric authentication of the influencer to prevent the influencer from hiring others to post in their name... An example of biometric authentication includes performing a face scan of influencer, an eye scan, or a fingerprint scan... biometric authentication may be performed when the influencer logs into their account, when the influencer posts content... when making a purchase of a product or service using the influence tracking ID."*
3. **Location tracking via Bluetooth Low Energy and Apple Location Services.** Patent: *"by using Bluetooth Low Energy—commonly referred to as BLE—technology to identify when a User device has entered a particular location... location tracking (such as, for example, Apple™ Location Services) could be used to track User in-store visits."*
4. **Machine-learning analysis of an influencer's posted content to infer purchases.** Patent: *"a machine learning system could be trained to analyze the content of an influencer's channel and identify events likely to correspond to a payment transaction, such as the appearance of new clothes on an influencer in a picture or video or a description of buying new clothes."*
5. **Tiered influence-chain tracking across multiple influencers.** Patent: *"In tiered tracking, the interactions of two or more influencers are considered... The concept of tiered tracking can be extended to track all influencers in 'tracked chain' of influence."*
6. **Integration with retailer point-of-sale systems for card-linked offers.** Patent: *"the exemplary platform would integrate directly with retailer point-of-sale systems in order to apply relevant retailer discounts and/or offers."*

Analytical framing — handle separately. The capability stack — biometric identification plus payment-instrument tracking plus content analysis plus influence-graph mapping — closely parallels what an intelligence officer would recognize as a foreign-influence-detection or counter-disinformation architecture, repurposed commercially. **This is interpretive analysis, not documentary capability.** The patent itself is unambiguous about its consumer-celebrity-influence purpose: the influencer-safety module specifically cites the murder of John Lennon as the use case

for delayed-posting features. The bridge to intelligence-architecture framing should remain in this audit memo as analytical observation. If it migrates to the node's Credibility Notes it must be flagged as analytical interpretation, not documented capability.

Co-inventor backgrounds.

Jason F. Fairchild is co-founder and CEO of tvScientific, a Connected TV advertising platform; previously co-founder and CRO of OpenX (2008–2020); earlier executive at GoTo.com / Overture / Yahoo (originator of the paid-search business model); Idealab portfolio; Duquesne University. He holds six patents in behavioral technology and search and several pending patents specifically in "audience data aggregation, CTV attribution and Social/Influencer commerce" (the last category covers the Reveal Systems family).

Self-reported revenue claim — qualified. Crunchbase, Advertising Week, and his LinkedIn all reproduce the same self-authored bio paragraph stating that under Fairchild's leadership "the company's annual revenue grew to \$700M+/year." OpenX's only published net-revenue figure is **\$172 million for 2017**, announced in a March 13, 2018 OpenX press release on openx.com. The \$700M+ figure has not been independently corroborated. The discrepancy is most plausibly explained by the figure conflating gross marketplace volume (ad spend transacted through the platform) with the company's own net revenue, but this is not stated in the Fairchild bio. The node should record the figure as self-reported with the qualifier and note the only audited number on record.

Erik T. Bogaard is described on his own LinkedIn as a "5x founder, fractional CPO" who runs Forge Lab; claims sole inventorship on six issued US patents for mobile and internet payments technology. **The six-patent claim is corroborated** by independently retrievable patent records assigned to Boom! Payments LLC / Boom! Payments, Inc., including US8271394B1, US8429084B1, US9235857B2, US10339525B2, US10878399, and US20130198035A1. These are separate from the three Reveal Systems filings (where Bogaard is one of three co-inventors), so there is no double-counting against the "sole inventor on six" claim. The Boom! Payments patents form the basis for a February 2019 patent-infringement suit by Boom against Shopify and Stripe.

The Reveal Systems patents fit neatly between Fairchild's adtech experience and Bogaard's payments-technology experience; Kirkpatrick's contribution is consistent with the influence-scoring and content-analysis algorithmic components.

Operating-status note. Reveal Systems Inc. has no documented public-facing product launch, marketing presence, or commercial activity surfaced in the searches conducted for this audit. The original patent application was abandoned; the two continuations were filed but no issued patent has resulted. State of incorporation, principals beyond the inventor list, current operating status, and funding history not retrieved this pass; OpenCorporates and state-registry queries not run.

Action: add four Timeline entries (provisional filing, original filing, first continuation, second continuation), with the second continuation explicitly flagged as filed during AARO directorship; update the Credibility Notes description of the product to reflect the actual scope; record both the "Reveal" brand and "Reveal Systems" corporate spellings; record Fairchild's revenue claim with the

qualifier; create the supporting nodes listed in section 6.

3.2 AARO Historical Record Report Volume 1 — Closed

Released March 8, 2024 under Phillips's acting directorship; signed by Kirkpatrick before his departure on December 1, 2023. Full title: *Report on the Historical Record of U.S. Government Involvement with Unidentified Anomalous Phenomena (UAP) Volume I*. Approximately 63 pages including bibliography. Volume I explicitly references a forthcoming Volume II "in accordance with the date established in Section 6802 of the National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 2023."

Related FOIA release (case 24-F-0894). The Black Vault retrieved a 14-page release of internal Pentagon emails covering correspondence about AARO and acting director Phillips between February 1 and March 7, 2024, obtained through a FOIA request for emails containing "AARO" or "Phillips" sent or received by Pentagon spokesperson Susan Gough. Two findings from this release are materially relevant:

Finding 1 — Tightly controlled rollout. Multiple journalists from Scientific American, the Washington Examiner, and Finland's national broadcaster YLE requested inclusion in press briefings or interviews with Phillips. Those requests were declined. Gough wrote: *"At this time, we are looking to keep any media engagement with AARO's acting director to a small group."* A small invite-only briefing was held on March 8, 2024 with about seven journalists present.

Finding 2 — ODNI deliberately omitted from rollout. ODNI is statutorily part of AARO's reporting chain under the FY2023 NDAA — AARO reports to both the Deputy Secretary of Defense and the Principal Deputy Director of National Intelligence (PDDNI). Despite this, in an email chain dated **March 5, 2024** discussing the draft press release, Gough asked whether ODNI should be referenced because *"the legislation calls for AARO producing the report — but Dir, AARO reports to PDDNI, too, so wanted to check."* The reply, with the sender redacted: *"Confirming that we're good without any ODNI mention."* The public rollout of the report Kirkpatrick signed was framed as DoD-only despite the statutory requirement.

Adjacent finding — sUAS portfolio dispute. The same release captures Gough writing **"We do not want to see sUAS added to AARO's portfolio!"** to David A. Kozik (Director of Congressional Activities, OUSD(I&S)) after Senator Gillibrand pressed for AARO to take on counter-drone coordination during a Senate briefing on drone incursions. Black Vault's analysis flags that a Public Affairs spokesperson taking a directive position on mission scope is unusual under DoD doctrine (Joint Publication 3-61, DoDD 5122.05, DoDI 5400.13, all of which limit Public Affairs to communications support rather than operational-mission decisions).

Action: create the document node for Vol 1 with the canonical DoD URL and AARO mirror; link from Kirkpatrick's Associated Nodes; create a separate document node for FOIA case 24-F-0894 covering the rollout-control emails; revise the Credibility Notes to acknowledge his signing role and the rollout-management context. The Gillibrand sUAS exchange should be noted as adjacent context relevant to AARO's institutional posture under Kirkpatrick's successor.

3.3 AARO Historical Record Report Volume 2 — Partial

As of April 2026, Volume II has not been publicly released. Public statements and reporting:

- Pentagon spokesperson Sue Gough confirmed in June 2025 that “the department is committed to releasing a second volume of its Historical Record Report, to include AARO’s findings on reports of potential pranks and inauthentic materials” and stated the release was expected “later in 2025.” That deadline has passed without a public release.
- The New Paradigm Institute reported in June 2025 that staff had been informed Vol II had been delivered to Congress in classified form, but it has not been publicly released.
- AARO director Jon Kosloski (appointed August 26, 2024) confirmed in a November 14, 2024 media roundtable that supporting Vol II production is among his “primary early responsibilities”; Pentagon spokesperson Pat Ryder told DefenseScoop that AARO “continue[s] to conduct their review, but we don’t have anything further to announce in terms of the timing of the report at this time.”
- Kirkpatrick gave extensive on-record interviews to the Wall Street Journal that previewed Vol II findings (covered in section 3.4).
- Representative Tim Burchett introduced HR 8197 on April 6, 2026 to terminate AARO within 60 days. The bill’s introduction post-dates the announced 2025 Vol II release window and reflects continued congressional dissatisfaction with AARO’s transparency posture.

Action: monitor for public release; create the document node when published. In the interim, treat the WSJ June 2025 reporting as the most substantive preview of Vol II content and flag the missed 2025 release window in the Credibility Notes.

3.4 Post-March-2024 Kirkpatrick public statements — Closed

The Wall Street Journal published “*The Pentagon Disinformation That Fueled America’s UFO Mythology*” on **June 6, 2025**, drawing on extensive on-record interviews with Kirkpatrick. The article documents two specific findings Kirkpatrick attributes to AARO’s Vol II–phase work:

1. **Cold War deception programs.** UFO mythology was substantially seeded by Air Force and DoD disinformation operations to deflect public attention from classified weapons programs — most prominently F-117 stealth-fighter testing at Area 51 in the 1980s. A retired Air Force colonel admitted to giving fabricated flying-saucer photos to a bar owner near Area 51 under official orders.
2. **The “Yankee Blue” hazing ritual.** A decades-long Air Force induction practice in which newly assigned commanders of classified programs were shown a staged flying-saucer photo, told they were joining a top-secret antigravity reverse-engineering project (“Yankee Blue”), and sworn to secrecy under threat of arrest, prison, or execution. AARO concluded the program was fictitious — a loyalty test that became institutionalized. Kirkpatrick’s aide is quoted: “*Ma’am, we know it went on for decades. We are talking about hundreds and hundreds of people. These men signed NDAs. They thought it was real.*” Following AARO’s discovery the Secretary of

Defense issued a memo ordering the practice to stop.

The article was widely covered by mainstream press (Jerusalem Post, FOX, others) and produced sharp pushback from UAP transparency advocates including Liberation Times (Marik von Rennenkampff) and the New Paradigm Institute, who argued the WSJ piece was itself a coordinated disinformation rollout designed to pre-frame Vol II and discredit whistleblowers.

Brandon Fugal Skinwalker Ranch photo controversy — Closed. A separate post-departure controversy is fully sourceable. In May 2024, Brandon Fugal (current owner of Skinwalker Ranch) publicly disputed Kirkpatrick's earlier on-camera denial to journalist Steven Greenstreet that Kirkpatrick had any prior interest or involvement in UAP before AARO. Per Greenstreet/Kirkpatrick split-screen interview transcript reporting:

- Greenstreet: "any interest at all in UFOs" prior to AARO? Kirkpatrick: not beyond movies.
- Greenstreet: "Before AARO, did you perform any duties regarding UFOs or paranormal phenomena?" Kirkpatrick: no.
- Greenstreet: "Did you attend a 2018 Senate Armed Services Committee briefing on Skinwalker Ranch?" Kirkpatrick: *"No, I attended a briefing at the request of Senate Armed Services Committee on what was at that time associated with the AATIP/AAWSAP research that was going on as an independent outside reviewer, and I gave them my opinions at that time."*

Fugal's account contradicts Kirkpatrick's framing on the third point. Per Fugal, on **April 19, 2018**, his Skinwalker Ranch team had been asked to provide a confidential 2.5-hour briefing in Washington DC to the Senate Select Committee on Intelligence and the Senate Armed Services Committee, and **Kirkpatrick "was at the head of the table"** — i.e., not an "independent outside reviewer." According to Fugal, Kirkpatrick told the briefing attendees they were "very well aware of the reality of the UFO phenomenon" and could "dispense with any part of your presentation that would seek to convince us of the reality because we already know."

On **May 9, 2024**, Fugal posted a photograph from the briefing on X (<https://x.com/BrandonFugal/status/1788708348340187605>) showing Kirkpatrick at the table while Fugal presented. Fugal subsequently provided EXIF metadata: *"the briefing occurred at on April 19, 2018 between 1:00-3:30pm ET. That particular photo was taken at 1:31pm."* On **June 22, 2024**, Liberation Times reported that the DoD had confirmed in writing to the publication that Kirkpatrick attended the April 19, 2018 briefing. Kirkpatrick has not publicly addressed the photo or the DoD confirmation.

Date coincidence. The April 19, 2018 Skinwalker Ranch briefing date is the same calendar day, five years earlier, as the **April 19, 2023 SASC public oversight hearing** at which Kirkpatrick gave his on-the-record opening testimony as AARO Director. The committees overlap (SASC participated in both). This coincidence does not appear to have been remarked on publicly. Recorded as a documented overlap; the audit makes no claim of significance.

April 2026 reappearance. Kirkpatrick made his first public reappearance after roughly two years of relative silence on **April 9, 2026** in Arlington, Virginia, at a National Capital Area Skeptics (NCAS)

event titled “All-domain Anomaly Resolution Office (AARO): a Duality in Mission Regarding UAPs,” where he restated the no-aliens / no-legacy-program conclusion. The video record is preserved on YouTube (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bi0H_mkwTW0).

Action: add Timeline entries for the WSJ June 6, 2025 interviews, the Yankee Blue / Cold War deception findings, the May 9, 2024 Fugal photo and April 19, 2018 SSCI/SASC briefing, the June 22, 2024 DoD confirmation of attendance, and the April 9, 2026 NCAS Arlington reappearance; capture key Kirkpatrick quotations from the WSJ piece in the Other Statements table; record the date coincidence as a footnote without claiming significance.

4. Credibility Notes — structural improvements

The substance of the Credibility Notes section is sound: each documented anomaly is sourced and the cluster of dates is materially relevant. The section’s structure can be improved without weakening the substance.

4.1 Replace the vague opener

Current: *“Several patterns in the documentary record are worth noting; full detail is in the Affiliations, Program Involvement, Timeline, and Relationships sections.”*

Recommended: state directly that the section documents specific anomalies in the public record concerning (a) post-AARO affiliations, (b) conduct while in office, (c) the November 2023 UAPDA legislative revisions and Kirkpatrick’s later characterization of them, and (d) statements about prior UAP involvement that are inconsistent with the documented record.

4.2 Group anomalies by category

The current presentation is a flat list. The anomalies fall into four coherent groups:

1. **Post-AARO affiliations with unusual documentation patterns** — ORNL title variants (COO vs. CTO designations across UT-Battelle internal memorandum, ORNL public profile, and NSSA forum agenda); profile takedown between December 8 and December 22, 2024 while other ORNL staff named Kirkpatrick retain live profiles.
2. **Conduct while in office** — Nonlinear Solutions LLC registered October 16, 2023; Reveal Systems patent continuation filed February 28, 2023; Mellon Signal messages June 11–13, 2023; all during AARO directorship.
3. **November 2023 UAPDA revisions** — the 33-page line-by-line OUSD(I&S) submission to congressional negotiators, and Kirkpatrick’s subsequent characterization that “we convinced Congress last year not to go down that road.”
4. **Statements about prior UAP involvement** — Kirkpatrick’s denial to Greenstreet of any pre-AARO UAP interest or involvement; Fugal’s photograph and DoD confirmation of his attendance at the April 19, 2018 SSCI/SASC Skinwalker Ranch briefing.

4.3 Surface the temporal cluster

Several events sit within a narrow window during the final months of AARO directorship:

- February 28, 2023 — Reveal Systems patent continuation filed
- October 16, 2023 — Nonlinear Solutions LLC registered
- November 2023 — OUSD(I&S) UAPDA revisions submitted
- November 8, 2023 — Departure announcement
- December 1, 2023 — Last day as Director
- December 2023 — Joins ORNL

A short timeline framing at the top of the section lets a reader see the cluster.

4.4 Move Mellon quotes into Statements

Per finding 1.4. Direct quotations belong in the standard Statements table format with attribution and source path, not in Credibility Notes prose. Transcribe directly from the FOIA release at case 24-F-0266.

4.5 Add the Vol 1 rollout-control note

Per finding 3.2, the FOIA case 24-F-0894 release shows the Pentagon deliberately downplayed ODNI's role in the public Vol 1 rollout despite the statutory reporting requirement under the FY2023 NDAA. This is a specific, sourced anomaly distinct from the existing notes. Quote the exact email-chain date (March 5, 2024) and the redacted-sender reply.

4.6 Add the Fugal photo / pre-AARO involvement note

Per finding 3.4, there is now a sourced disjunction between Kirkpatrick's recorded statement about his pre-AARO UAP role posture and the DoD's written confirmation that he attended the April 19, 2018 SSCI/SASC Skinwalker Ranch briefing. Fugal's photograph (with verified EXIF metadata at 1:31pm ET on April 19, 2018) corroborates not only attendance but a leadership posture at the briefing. This belongs in the Credibility Notes as group (d) under recommendation 4.2.

5. Appointing-chain context (Moultrie material)

Material drawn from Moultrie's June 2018 LinkedIn capture and corroborating public sources establishes that the appointing official for AARO had a substantial pre-government private-sector portfolio. This is relevant context for the Kirkpatrick node, though the bulk of the detail belongs in a `/people/ronald-moultrie` node.

5.1 Confirmation dates

Senate confirmation: May 29, 2021. Sworn in as USD(I&S): June 1, 2021.

5.2 C5 Capital — escalated role

The LinkedIn capture lists “Strategic Partner, C5 Capital” from January 2017. Public sources establish that Moultrie was elevated to **Chairman of C5 US** by December 2017, when he appeared in that title at the IISS Manama Dialogue panel. C5 Capital is a London-headquartered specialist VC firm investing exclusively in cybersecurity, space, and (later) nuclear energy. Portfolio companies include Axiom Space (commercial space station) and X-energy (advanced modular reactors). CEO and founder is André Pienaar.

5.3 Battelle ↔ UT-Battelle relationship — Closed

UT-Battelle, LLC was established in 1999 as a Tennessee nonprofit limited liability company. It is a 50/50 joint venture between the University of Tennessee and Battelle Memorial Institute (a nonprofit headquartered in Columbus, Ohio) and has held the management contract for ORNL since April 1, 2000, with five-year renewals in 2005, 2010, 2015, 2020, and most recently March 2025. Battelle Memorial Institute also operates Pacific Northwest National Laboratory and is a partner in managing Brookhaven National Laboratory and the National Renewable Energy Laboratory; it manages seven national laboratories total for the Department of Energy and Department of Homeland Security.

Moultrie’s advisory board seat was at the parent — Battelle Memorial Institute — from July 2016 to April 2018. The role ended approximately three years before his USD(I&S) confirmation and approximately five years before Kirkpatrick joined ORNL (December 2023). The temporal gap weakens but does not eliminate the relevance of the Moultrie–Battelle–ORNL link in the Kirkpatrick Credibility Notes section. Honest framing: the appointing official had a prior, then-concluded board relationship with one of the two co-equal members of the joint venture managing Kirkpatrick’s post-AARO employer; Kirkpatrick’s ORNL position is downstream by 5+ years.

5.4 Recommended addition to Credibility Notes

A new note, distinct from the existing notes about Kirkpatrick’s own conduct:

The official who selected Kirkpatrick for AARO (Ronald Moultrie, USD(I&S) from June 1, 2021) operated a cybersecurity advisory LLC during his 2015–2021 government interregnum (Oceanus Security Strategies, founded November 2015) with stated VC and hedge-fund clientele, served as Chairman C5 US for the cybersecurity-and-space VC firm C5 Capital, and held an advisory board seat at Battelle Memorial Institute (July 2016 – April 2018) — one of the two co-equal members of UT-Battelle, LLC, the joint venture that has managed ORNL since April 2000. Kirkpatrick took a senior position at ORNL weeks after departing AARO. Each leg is independently sourced; the cluster is what this note documents. The note does not assert that Moultrie’s private-sector activity influenced his AARO personnel decisions.

5.5 Pre-government affiliations to record on the Moultrie node

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Organization	Role	Period
Oceanus Security Strategies, LLC	President & CEO	November 2015 – June 2021
C5 Capital	Strategic Partner → Chairman C5 US	January 2017 – ~2021
Battelle Memorial Institute	Advisory Board Member	July 2016 – April 2018
RIWI Corp.	Senior Advisor	January 2017 – ~2021
ITC Global Advisors	Senior Advisor	July 2016 – ~2021
Resolute Consulting LLC	Cyber Security Advisory Board	May 2018 – ~2021
G2K Labs Inc.	Chairman of the Board	LinkedIn-listed; period unconfirmed
Better Angels Society	Board Member	June 2016 – ~2021
Altamira Technologies	Board Member	per ExecutiveBiz 2021
Sequoia	Board Member	per ExecutiveBiz 2021
iCapital Network	Board Member	per ExecutiveBiz 2021
Mitre	Senior Advisor	per ExecutiveBiz 2021
Pallas	Senior Advisor	per ExecutiveBiz 2021
BlueVoyant	Vice Chairman, Advisory Board	June 2021, during nomination period

The SASC pre-hearing Statement and Advance Policy Questions are linked from the May 2021 nomination hearing page. The APQ is the canonical document for what Moultrie disclosed to the committee about his private-sector portfolio and is recommended retrieval for the Moultrie node.

6. Recommended new nodes

The following nodes are surfaced by this audit and should be created or stubbed:

Node	Purpose
<code>/organizations/reveal-systems-inc</code>	Patent assignee for three Bogaard / Fairchild / Kirkpatrick filings; record both "Reveal Systems" corporate spelling and "Reveel" brand

/people/erik-bogaard	Co-inventor; founder of Forge Lab; six payments-technology patents via Boom! Payments
/people/jason-fairchild	Co-inventor; CEO tvScientific; co-founder OpenX; GoTo.com alumnus
/organizations/battelle-memorial-institute	Moultrie advisory board 2016–2018; co-equal member of UT-Battelle
/organizations/ut-battelle	ORNL management joint venture; member organizations and contract history
/organizations/c5-capital	London-headquartered specialist VC; Moultrie role 2017–~2021
/documents/aaro-historical-record-report-vol-1	Signed by Kirkpatrick; released March 8, 2024
/documents/aaro-historical-record-report-vol-2	Forthcoming under Kosloski
/documents/foia-24-f-0266	Black Vault release; Mellon Signal messages and Grusch correspondence
/documents/foia-24-f-0894	Black Vault release; Pentagon Vol 1 rollout-control emails and sUAS portfolio dispute
/documents/abba-memorandum-20230308	DoD SAPCO memorandum confirming AARO statutory authority across classification levels (released within FOIA 24-F-0266)
/documents/wsj-pentagon-ufo-disinformation-20250606	Vol 2 preview interviews with Kirkpatrick
/documents/fugal-skinwalker-2018-photo	Documents Kirkpatrick attendance at SSCI/SASC briefing despite his denial to Greenstreet

7. Items still open

Item	What is missing
The four other “new-start organizations”	Not enumerated in any retrieved bio; AFRL Ultrafast Laser Physics Lab (1997), Advanced Systems Division CIA-DIA office (2007), and a structure under DIO/S&TI

	(2012–2016) are plausible candidates but not labeled as such in any source
AARO HRR Volume 2 public release	Reportedly delivered to Congress in classified form mid-2025; public release deadline of “later in 2025” missed; no timing commitment as of April 2026
Reveal Systems Inc. corporate registration	State of incorporation, principals beyond inventor list, current operating status, funding history — would require direct OpenCorporates access or state-registry queries; the “Reveal” brand spelling was not used as the corporate name
Atlanta Journal 11 July 1986 article	Currently sourced via Wikipedia citation only; would require ProQuest or regional library archive access
Mellon Signal reply text (full)	The released screenshot was cut off; Black Vault has filed an appeal under FOIA 24-F-0266 for the redacted portion
2007 Advanced Systems Division placement	Sourced only to Potomac Officers Club speaker page; not corroborated against the DoD bio’s organizational language

8. Minor

The UGA degrees row in the Affiliations table has an empty Source column even though the DoD bio is the obvious source.

The Aliases field contains only “Dr. K,” which is a workplace nickname rather than an alias in any identity-tracking sense. However, the term has documentary basis in the official DoD bio: *“Known as Dr. K to his staff and team.”* If the Aliases field is removed, retain the phrase in the Background section with citation.

The Timeline entry for the July 26, 2023 Grusch testimony is categorized “other,” but it is the proximate trigger for the Hicks oversight transition documented in the August 30, 2023 entry; consider linking the two entries explicitly.

Appendix: Primary-source URLs verified during this audit

Kirkpatrick

Topic	URL
DoD biography (July 2022)	https://media.defense.gov/2022/Jul/20/2003039076/-1/-1/1/DR-SEAN-M-KIRKPATRICK-BIOGRAPHY.PDF
AFCEA biography (USSPACECOM- era; closes 2018 gap)	https://www.afcea.org/event/sites/default/files/files/Kirkpatrick_Sean%20DR%20Bio.pdf
WestExec Advisors profile	https://www.westexec.com/sean-kirkpatrick/
Elara Nova profile	https://elaranova.com/team-members/sean-kirkpatrick/
Potomac Officers Club bio (Advanced Systems Division detail)	https://www.potomacofficersclub.com/speakers/dr-sean-kirkpatrick/
HandWiki biography (cross- reference index)	https://handwiki.org/wiki/Biography:Sean_M._Kirkpatrick
UGA directory page	https://www.physast.uga.edu/directory/people/sean-kirkpatrick
UGA Sean M. Kirkpatrick Award	https://www.physast.uga.edu/academic_programs/grad/graduate-awards
SASC oral remarks (April 2023)	https://www.armed-services.senate.gov/imo/media/doc/Dr.%20Kirkpatrick%20Oral%20Remarks%20-%20SASC%20ETC%20Open%20Hearing%204.19.23%20FINAL.pdf
April 9, 2026 NCAS reappearance (YouTube)	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bi0H_mkwTW0

Reveal Systems patent family

Document	URL

US20200357080A1 (original, abandoned)	https://patents.google.com/patent/US20200357080A1/en
US20220084137A1 (first continuation)	https://patents.google.com/patent/US20220084137A1/en
US20230206351A1 (second continuation)	https://patents.google.com/patent/US20230206351A1/en
Patent Center filing record	https://patentcenter.uspto.gov/applications/16869390
Erik Bogaard LinkedIn	https://www.linkedin.com/in/erikbogaard/
Bogaard patent inventor index (Justia)	https://patents.justia.com/inventor/erik-t-bogaard
Boom! Payments assignee index (Justia)	https://patents.justia.com/assignee/boom-payments-inc
Boom! Payments US8271394B1	https://patents.google.com/patent/US8271394
Boom! Payments US8429084B1	https://patents.google.com/patent/US8429084
Boom! v. Shopify/Stripe coverage (WIPR via InventionDaily, Feb 2019)	http://inventiondaily.com/shopify-tangled-up-in-online-payment-patent-suit-world-intellectual-property-review/
Jason Fairchild LinkedIn	https://www.linkedin.com/in/jasonfairchild
Fairchild Crunchbase	https://www.crunchbase.com/person/jason-fairchild
Fairchild Advertising Week speaker bio (2024)	https://newyork2024.advertisingweek.com/aw/schedule/speaker/-1539
OpenX 2017 net revenue announcement (\$172M)	https://www.openx.com/press-releases/openx-announces-10th-straight-year-growth-4th-straight-year-profitability-business-surges-172-million-net-revenue-2017/
OpenX Wikipedia	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/OpenX_(company)

AARO

Document	URL
Historical Record Report Vol 1 (DoD)	https://media.defense.gov/2024/Mar/08/2003409233/-1/-1/0/DOPSR-CLEARED-508-COMPLIANT-HRRV1-08-MAR-2024-FINAL.PDF

canonical)	
Historical Record Report Vol 1 (AARO mirror)	https://www.aaro.mil/Portals/136/PDFs/AARO_Historical_Record_Report_Vol_1_2024.pdf
Library of Congress catalog entry	https://id.loc.gov/authorities/names/no2023107732
FOIA 24-F-0266 release package (Mellon Signal messages, Abba memo, Grusch outreach MFR)	https://documents2.theblackvault.com/documents/osd/24-F-0266.pdf
FOIA 24-F-0266 (AARO mirror)	https://www.aaro.mil/Portals/136/PDFs/FOIA/2024%20FOIAs/24-F-0266.pdf
FOIA 24-F-0266 Black Vault analysis (April 18, 2024)	https://www.theblackvault.com/documentarchive/foia-documents-reveal-aaros-authorized-and-repeated-attempts-to-engage-with-david-grusch/
FOIA 24-F-0894 release package (Vol 1 rollout emails, sUAS portfolio dispute)	https://documents2.theblackvault.com/documents/osd/24-F-0894.pdf
FOIA 24-F-0894 Black Vault analysis (August 27, 2025)	https://www.theblackvault.com/documentarchive/foia-emails-reveal-pentagons-tight-control-over-aaro-historical-record-report-rollout-and-messaging/
Kosloski first media roundtable (November 14, 2024)	https://www.theblackvault.com/documentarchive/transcript-dr-jon-kosloski-director-aaro-media-roundtable-on-the-fy24-consolidated-annual-report-on-uap-november-14-2024/
Kosloski	https://defensescoop.com/2024/08/26/leader-pentagon-uap-investigation-hub-jon-

appointment (DefenseScoop)	kosloski/
HR 8197 Congress.gov titles page	https://www.congress.gov/bill/119th-congress/house-bill/8197/titles

JICSpOC / NSDC

Document	URL
DoD JICSpOC establishment release (September 11, 2015)	https://www.war.gov/News/Releases/Release/Article/616969/new-joint-interagency-combined-space-operations-center-to-be-established/
SpaceNews coverage of NSDC rename (April 2017)	https://spacenews.com/the-jicspoc-is-dead-long-live-the-national-space-defense-center/
National Space Defense Center Wikipedia	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/National_Space_Defense_Center

Post-March-2024 Kirkpatrick statements

Document	URL
WSJ Vol II preview coverage (PJ Media reporting)	https://pjmedia.com/rick-moran/2025/06/07/the-disinformation-campaign-to-hide-secret-technology-led-to-the-creation-of-myths-about-ufos-n4940545
WSJ piece (tovima.com mirror)	https://www.tovima.com/wsj/the-pentagon-disinformation-that-fueled-americas-ufo-mythology/
FOX coverage of WSJ piece	https://www.livenowfox.com/news/ufo-disinfo-cold-war-stealth-coverup
Jerusalem Post coverage of WSJ piece	https://www.jpost.com/omg/article-856910
Liberation Times rebuttal (Marik von Rennenkampff)	https://www.liberationtimes.com/home/from-moscow-to-malmstrom-russian-style-disinformation-tactics-target-us-ufo-transparency-efforts
New Paradigm Institute response	https://newparadigminstitute.org/learn/library/using-the-wall-street-journal-the-pentagon-is-gaslighting-the-public-on-ufos-again/
Fugal photo (X post May 9, 2024)	https://x.com/BrandonFugal/status/1788708348340187605

Fugal denial follow-up (X post May 9, 2024)	https://x.com/BrandonFugal/status/1788707062408421795
Unknown Country writeup of Fugal vs. Kirkpatrick	https://unknowncountry.com/headline-news/undisclosed-2018-meeting-by-former-aaro-head-sean-kirkpatrick-with-skinwalker-ranch-researchers-calls-government-transparency-into-question/
PostApocalypticMedia writeup (with metadata reference)	https://www.postapocalypticmedia.com/fugal-kirpatrick-skinwalker-ranch-meeting/
The UFO Chronicles coverage (Billy Cox column)	https://www.theufochronicles.com/2024/06/senate-briefing-on-skinwalker-ranch-and.html

UT-Battelle / ORNL

Document	URL
UT-Battelle official site	https://www.ut-battelle.org/about/
UT-Battelle Wikipedia	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/UT%E2%80%93Battelle
2010 contract extension press release	https://news.tennessee.edu/2010/03/23/u-s-department-energy-extends-ut-battelle-contract-manage-oak-ridge-national-laboratory/
2025 contract extension	https://www.teknovention.biz/ut-battelle-will-continue-management-of-ornl-for-next-five-years/
UT Volopedia history	https://volopedia.lib.utk.edu/entries/oak-ridge-national-laboratory-management-contract-ut-battelle/

Moultrie

Document	URL
Biden White House nomination announcement (April 2021)	https://bidenwhitehouse.archives.gov/briefing-room/statements-releases/2021/04/02/president-biden-announces-his-intent-to-nominate-key-members-for-the-department-of-defense/
SASC nomination hearing (statements)	https://www.armed-services.senate.gov/hearings/nomination_mccord-

and APQ)	and-moultrie
C5 Capital strategic-partner announcement (March 2017)	https://mondovisione.com/media-and-resources/news/c5-partners-appoints-former-us-national-security-agency-director-of-operations/
C5 Capital IISS Manama panel — listed as Chairman C5 US (December 2017)	https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20171212005613/en/
Defense One nomination-hearing coverage	https://www.defenseone.com/defense-systems/2021/05/moultries-cyber-background-clears-confirmation-path/195126/
Defense News Senate confirmation (May 2021)	https://www.defensenews.com/congress/2021/05/28/senate-confirms-pentagon-finance-and-intel-chiefs/
BlueVoyant advisory board appointment (June 2021)	https://www.executivebiz.com/articles/bluevoyant-names-debora-plunkett-ariel-litvin-to-board-of-directors-ronald-moultrie-to-advisory-board
LeoLabs board appointment (December 2024)	https://www.executivebiz.com/articles/dod-intelligence-ronald-moultrie-leolabs-board-of-directors
DoD official biography	https://www.war.gov/About/Biographies/Biography/Article/2764848/ronald-s-moultrie/